

using tunnels and huge stone bridges to overcome hills, valleys, and any other obstacles that stood in their way.

mourners (whose job was to wail and cry) walked slowly in a funeral procession toward a cemetery outside the town. At

ROASTED DORMICE, DIPPED IN HONEY, WERE A FAVORITE ROMAN SNACK.

Health, death, and burial

Romans suffered from the same diseases and illnesses as we do, but their life expectancy was shorter. Only the wealthy, who ate good food and could afford doctors and medical treatment, were more likely to live past their 60th birthday. The poor were lucky to reach their 40s or 50s. After they died, people were usually buried rather than cremated. Relatives, flute-players, and professional

a rich person's funeral, relatives wore masks to represent the dead person's ancestors—it was a way of bringing the family together. The Romans believed that the spirit lived on after death, but they only had vague ideas of what the afterlife was like.

THE PONT DU GARD, SOUTHERN FRANCE, WAS BOTH AN AQUEDUCT (TOP LEVEL) AND A ROAD BRIDGE (BOTTOM LEVEL).

